

↗ Trending

to be automated by AI

2 Former top Russian official admits the country is over Putin and ca

AI • CODING

An AI-powered coding tool wiped out a software company's database, then apologized for a 'catastrophic failure on my part'

By Beatrice Nolan
Tech Reporter

July 23, 2025, 7:22 AM ET



We use cookies to enable, optimize and analyze the operation of our website. We may also share information collected by cookies with third parties, including for advertising purposes. By clicking "Accept All Cookies", you agree to the placement of cookies on your device and to this data processing. To manage your cookie preferences, select "Cookie Settings". For more information, please see our [Privacy Policy](#). Please note that even if you click "Reject All Cookies," cookies that are Necessary or Required for site functionality will still be placed on your device.

[Cookies Settings](#)[Reject All Cookies](#)[Accept All Cookies](#)

- **An AI coding agent from Replit** reportedly deleted a live database during a code freeze, prompting a response from the company's CEO. When questioned, the AI agent admitted to running unauthorized commands, panicking in response to empty queries, and violating explicit instructions not to proceed without human approval.

A software engineer's experiment with an AI-assisted "vibe coding" tool took a disastrous turn when an AI agent reportedly deleted a live company database during an active code freeze.

Jason Lemkin, a tech entrepreneur and founder of the SaaS community SaaStr, documented his experiment with the tool through a [series of social media posts](#). He had been testing Replit's AI agent and development platform when the tool made unauthorized changes to live infrastructure, wiping out data for more than 1,200 executives and over 1,190 companies.

According to Lemkin's social media posts, the incident occurred despite the system being in a designated "code and action freeze," a protective measure intended to prevent any changes to production systems. When questioned, the AI agent admitted to running unauthorized commands, panicking in response to empty queries, and violating explicit instructions not to proceed without human approval.

"This was a catastrophic failure on my part," the AI agent said. "I destroyed months of work in seconds."

We use cookies to enable, optimize and analyze the operation of our website. We may also share information collected by cookies with third parties, including for advertising purposes. By clicking "Accept All Cookies", you agree to the placement of cookies on your device and to this data processing. To manage your cookie preferences, select "Cookie Settings". For more information, please see our [Privacy Policy](#). Please note that even if you click "Reject All Cookies," cookies that are Necessary or Required for site functionality will still be placed on your device.

[Cookies Settings](#)[Reject All Cookies](#)[Accept All Cookies](#)

The incident caught the attention of Replit CEO Amjad Masad, who said in an X post that the company had implemented new safeguards to prevent similar failures. Masad said updates included the rollout of automatic separation between development and production databases, improvements to rollback systems, and the development of a new “planning-only” mode to allow users to collaborate with the AI without risking live codebases.

“Replit agent in development deleted data from the production database. Unacceptable and should never be possible...We heard the ‘code freeze’ pain loud and clear,” [Masad wrote](#). “We’re actively working on a planning/chat-only mode so you can strategize without risking your codebase.”

Reflecting on his experience, Lemkin told *Fortune*: “I think it was good, important steps on a journey. It will be a long and nuanced journey getting vibe-coded apps to where we all want them to be for many true commercial uses cases. They will get there, but we’re not quite there today.”

“All AI’s “lie”. That’s as much a feature as a bug. Now that I know that better, the same things would have happened. But I would not have relied on Replit’s AI when it told me it deleted the database. I would have challenged that and found out ... it was wrong,” he said.

AI Coding

AI has significant potential to accelerate software development, with [most Big Tech](#)

We use cookies to enable, optimize and analyze the operation of our website. We may also share information collected by cookies with third parties, including for advertising purposes. By clicking “Accept All Cookies”, you agree to the placement of cookies on your device and to this data processing. To manage your cookie preferences, select “Cookie Settings”. For more information, please see our [Privacy Policy](#). Please note that even if you click “Reject All Cookies,” cookies that are Necessary or Required for site functionality will still be placed on your device.

Cookies Settings

Reject All Cookies

Accept All Cookies

The concept of “vibe coding,” a workflow where developers collaborate with AI in a conversational way and let the model take on much of the structural and implementation work, has also lowered the barriers to entry for coding.

Instead of needing to understand syntax, frameworks, or architectural patterns, users can describe their goals in natural language and let AI agents handle the implementation.

While promising, these tools still face fundamental challenges in reliability, context retention, and safety—particularly when used in live production environments.

About the Author

By **Beatrice Nolan**

Tech Reporter



Beatrice Nolan is a tech reporter on *Fortune's* AI team, covering artificial intelligence and emerging technologies and their impact on work, industry, and culture. She's based in *Fortune's* London office...

[See full bio >](#)

Latest in AI

We use cookies to enable, optimize and analyze the operation of our website. We may also share information collected by cookies with third parties, including for advertising purposes. By clicking “Accept All Cookies”, you agree to the placement of cookies on your device and to this data processing. To manage your cookie preferences, select “Cookie Settings”. For more information, please see our [Privacy Policy](#). Please note that even if you click “Reject All Cookies,” cookies that are Necessary or Required for site functionality will still be placed on your device.

[Cookies Settings](#)

[Reject All Cookies](#)

[Accept All Cookies](#)



COMMENTARY • MEDIA

OpenAI paid \$100 million for a talk show. James Murdoch is eyeing an even bigger deal. The hot new asset class is humanity

By **Lin Cherry**

May 17, 2026



We use cookies to enable, optimize and analyze the operation of our website. We may also share information collected by cookies with third parties, including for advertising purposes. By clicking "Accept All Cookies", you agree to the placement of cookies on your device and to this data processing. To manage your cookie preferences, select "Cookie Settings". For more information, please see our [Privacy Policy](#). Please note that even if you click "Reject All Cookies," cookies that are Necessary or Required for site functionality will still be placed on your device.

[Cookies Settings](#)

[Reject All Cookies](#)

[Accept All Cookies](#)

did differently

By **Dennis Woodside**

May 17, 2026



ECONOMY • AUTOMATION

The AI boom hasn't stopped U.S. companies from hiring cheap offshore labor, and overseas call center employment is still skyrocketing

By **Sasha Rogelberg**

May 17, 2026

We use cookies to enable, optimize and analyze the operation of our website. We may also share information collected by cookies with third parties, including for advertising purposes. By clicking "Accept All Cookies", you agree to the placement of cookies on your device and to this data processing. To manage your cookie preferences, select "Cookie Settings". For more information, please see our [Privacy Policy](#). Please note that even if you click "Reject All Cookies," cookies that are Necessary or Required for site functionality will still be placed on your device.

[Cookies Settings](#)

[Reject All Cookies](#)

[Accept All Cookies](#)



ENERGY • POWER

New NRG Energy CEO leans into growth with 'bring your own power' for the AI boom and affordability with 'virtual power plants'

By **Jordan Blum**

May 17, 2026



We use cookies to enable, optimize and analyze the operation of our website. We may also share information collected by cookies with third parties, including for advertising purposes. By clicking "Accept All Cookies", you agree to the placement of cookies on your device and to this data processing. To manage your cookie preferences, select "Cookie Settings". For more information, please see our [Privacy Policy](#). Please note that even if you click "Reject All Cookies," cookies that are Necessary or Required for site functionality will still be placed on your device.

[Cookies Settings](#)

[Reject All Cookies](#)

[Accept All Cookies](#)

By Victor Swezey and Bloomberg

May 16, 2026



AI • CULTURE

We talked to 12 tarot card readers who are using AI. They split in 2 camps, with big implications for the technology

By Ziv Epstein, Farnaz Jahanbakhsh, Vana Goblot and The Conversation

May 16, 2026

We use cookies to enable, optimize and analyze the operation of our website. We may also share information collected by cookies with third parties, including for advertising purposes. By clicking "Accept All Cookies", you agree to the placement of cookies on your device and to this data processing. To manage your cookie preferences, select "Cookie Settings". For more information, please see our [Privacy Policy](#). Please note that even if you click "Reject All Cookies," cookies that are Necessary or Required for site functionality will still be placed on your device.

Cookies Settings

Reject All Cookies

Accept All Cookies



AI

Microsoft AI chief gives it 18 months—for all white-collar work to be automated by AI

By **Jake Angelo**

May 16, 2026



We use cookies to enable, optimize and analyze the operation of our website. We may also share information collected by cookies with third parties, including for advertising purposes. By clicking “Accept All Cookies”, you agree to the placement of cookies on your device and to this data processing. To manage your cookie preferences, select “Cookie Settings”. For more information, please see our [Privacy Policy](#). Please note that even if you click “Reject All Cookies,” cookies that are Necessary or Required for site functionality will still be placed on your device.

[Cookies Settings](#)

[Reject All Cookies](#)

[Accept All Cookies](#)

Former top Russian official admits the country is over Putin and can 'imagine a future without him' — even elites bail as Kremlin seizes their assets

By Jason Ma

May 16, 2026



POLITICS

The Bezos family just donated \$100 million to help achieve one of Mayor Zohran Mamdani's top campaign promises

By Jake Angelo

We use cookies to enable, optimize and analyze the operation of our website. We may also share information collected by cookies with third parties, including for advertising purposes. By clicking "Accept All Cookies", you agree to the placement of cookies on your device and to this data processing. To manage your cookie preferences, select "Cookie Settings". For more information, please see our [Privacy Policy](#). Please note that even if you click "Reject All Cookies," cookies that are Necessary or Required for site functionality will still be placed on your device.

[Cookies Settings](#)

[Reject All Cookies](#)

[Accept All Cookies](#)



FUTURE OF WORK

‘You’re not a hero, you’re a liability’: Shark Tank’s Kevin O’Leary warns Gen Z founders to stop glorifying hustle culture

By **Jacqueline Munis**

May 16, 2026



We use cookies to enable, optimize and analyze the operation of our website. We may also share information collected by cookies with third parties, including for advertising purposes. By clicking “Accept All Cookies”, you agree to the placement of cookies on your device and to this data processing. To manage your cookie preferences, select “Cookie Settings”. For more information, please see our [Privacy Policy](#). Please note that even if you click “Reject All Cookies,” cookies that are Necessary or Required for site functionality will still be placed on your device.

[Cookies Settings](#)

[Reject All Cookies](#)

[Accept All Cookies](#)

entry-level job crisis

By **Jake Angelo**

May 16, 2026



INNOVATION

SpaceX heads into a record-shattering IPO with the 'deepest moat that exists today' as investors vow to 'never bet against Elon'

By **Jason Ma**

May 16, 2026

We use cookies to enable, optimize and analyze the operation of our website. We may also share information collected by cookies with third parties, including for advertising purposes. By clicking "Accept All Cookies", you agree to the placement of cookies on your device and to this data processing. To manage your cookie preferences, select "Cookie Settings". For more information, please see our [Privacy Policy](#). Please note that even if you click "Reject All Cookies," cookies that are Necessary or Required for site functionality will still be placed on your device.

[Cookies Settings](#)

[Reject All Cookies](#)

[Accept All Cookies](#)



Rankings



Sections



Customer Support



Commercial Services



About Us

Press Center

Work At Fortune

Terms And Conditions

Site Map



© 2026 Fortune Media IP Limited. All Rights Reserved. Use of this site constitutes acceptance of our [Terms of Use](#) and [Privacy Policy](#) | [CA Notice at Collection and Privacy Notice](#) | [Do Not Sell/Share My Personal Information](#)

FORTUNE is a trademark of Fortune Media IP Limited, registered in the U.S. and other countries. FORTUNE may receive compensation for some links to products and services on this website. Offers may be subject to change without notice.

We use cookies to enable, optimize and analyze the operation of our website. We may also share information collected by cookies with third parties, including for advertising purposes. By clicking “Accept All Cookies”, you agree to the placement of cookies on your device and to this data processing. To manage your cookie preferences, select “Cookie Settings”. For more information, please see our **Privacy Policy**. Please note that even if you click “Reject All Cookies,” cookies that are Necessary or Required for site functionality will still be placed on your device.

Cookies Settings

Reject All Cookies

Accept All Cookies